ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 62

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Swahili Alphabet

Alfabeti yangu ya kwanza ya Kiswahili

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 30 Swahili Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b D d

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Swahili Alphabet — Alfabeti yangu ya kwanza ya Kiswahili
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 62

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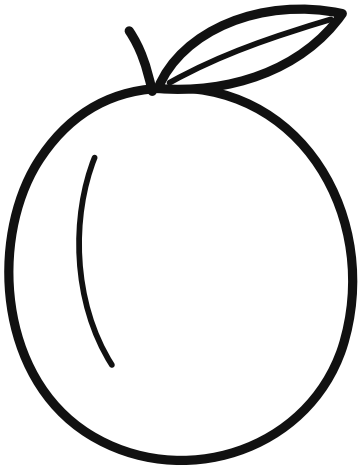
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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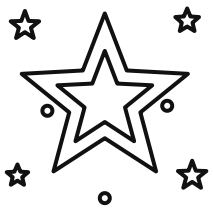
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



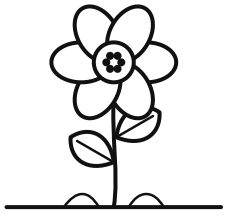
This book belongs to

Kitabu hiki ni cha

I started learning Swahili on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 62 is Swahili. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: *a-SA-lee* means "say SA a little louder". In Swahili the stress is almost always on the next-to-last syllable.
- **m-** and **n-** at the start of a word are said as a short hum: *m-see-KEE-tee*.
- **gh** is a soft gargle in the throat; **th** is "think", **dh** is "this".
- Every vowel is said on its own: *ua* is two beats, *OO-a*.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Swahili name** written in Swahili (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Swahili name · syllables* shows the name Swahili children use for the letter (B is «be», CH is «che») and its row of syllables — the way Swahili is taught in school.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Swahili (Kiswahili sanifu) as taught in Tanzania and Kenya.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Swahili! Kiswahili

kee-swa-HEE-lee — the Swahili word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **70 million people** speak Swahili — most of them learn it as a second language, so people from many different families can talk together.[3]

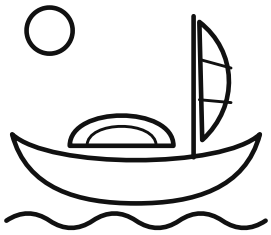
Where?
Along the **East African coast** and far inland: in **Tanzania**, **Kenya**, **Uganda**, the eastern **Congo** and nearby lands, and on islands such as **Zanzibar**.

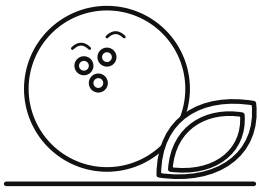
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**. For hundreds of years before that, Swahili poems and letters were written in **Arabic letters**.

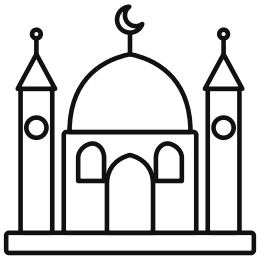
How many letters?
24 letters, plus **letter pairs** such as *sh*, *ny* and *ng'* for special sounds.

A name from the coast
The name *Swahili* comes from the Arabic word *sawāḥil*, "coasts". It began as the language of the seaside towns!

Did you know?
Many Swahili words come from Arabic: *kitabu* (book, from *kitāb*), *msikiti* (mosque, from *masjid*), *dunia* (world) and *saa* (hour, clock).







The Swahili Alphabet alfabeti

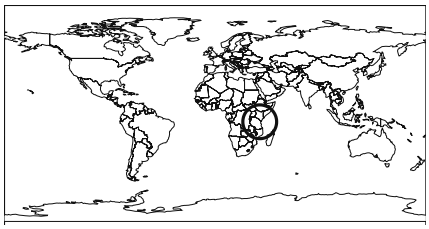
24 letters — herufi za Kiswahili

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *beh*	**Ch ch** *cheh*	**Dd** *deh*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *feh*
Gg *geh*	**Hh** *heh*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jeh*	**Kk** *keh*	**Ll** *leh*
Mm *meh*	**Nn** *neh*	**Oo** *oh*	**Pp** *peh*	**Rr** *reh*	**Ss** *seh*
Tt *teh*	**Uu** *oo*	**Vv** *veh*	**Ww** *weh*	**Yy** *yeh*	**Zz** *zeh*

6 letter pairs — herufi mbili

Dh dh *thah*	**Gh gh** *ghah*	**Ng' ng'** *ngah*	**Ny ny** *nyah*	**Sh sh** *shah*	**Th th** *thah*

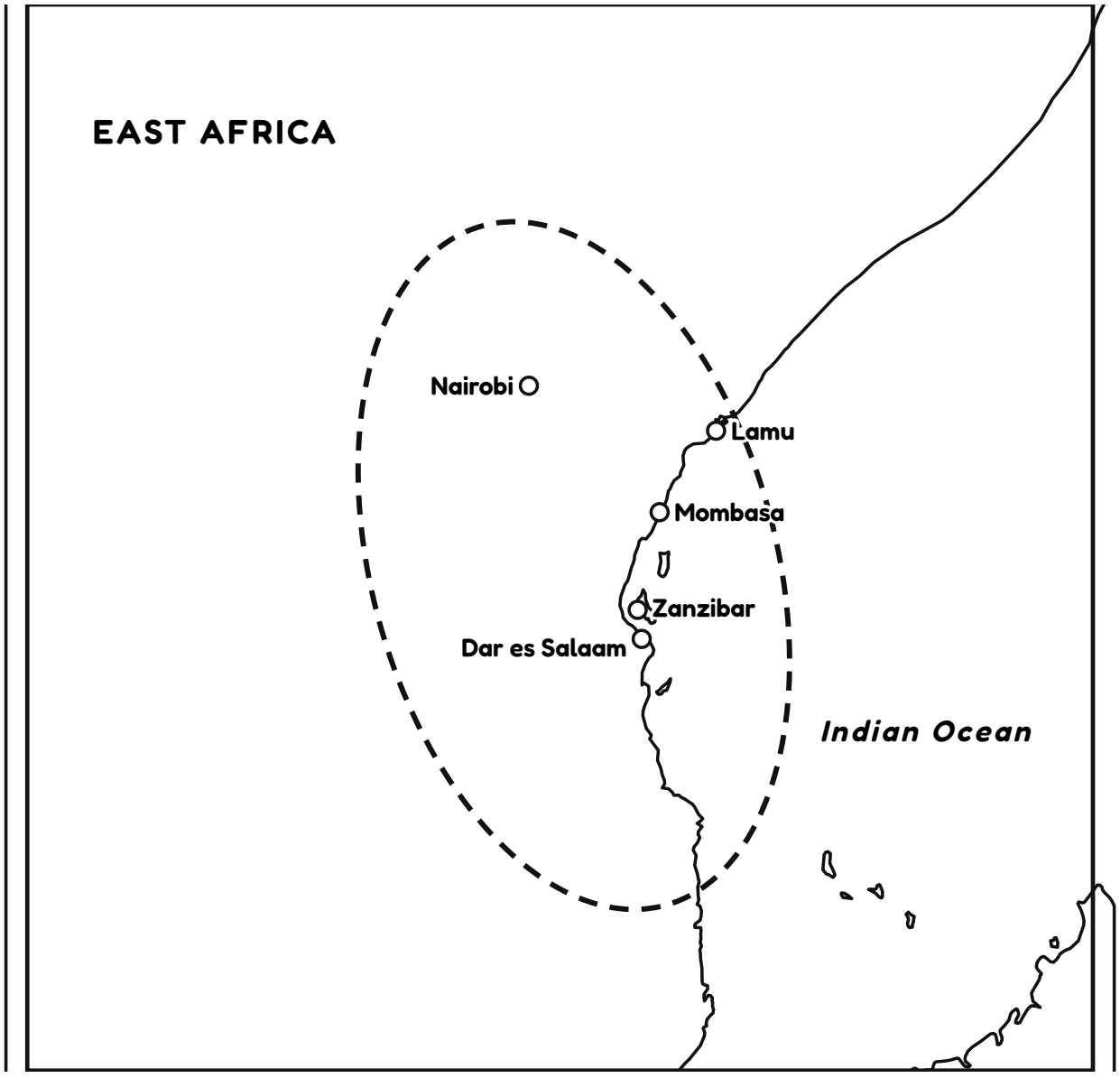
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows East Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Swahili spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Swahili is spoken in Lamu, Mombasa, Zanzibar, Dar es Salaam, Nairobi and all across East Africa. The dashed line shows where most Swahili speakers live.

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THE LETTERS

The Letters herufi za Kiswahili

heh-ROO-fee za kee-swa-HEE-lee — “the Swahili letters”

Swahili is written with **24 letters**. It has no Q and no X, and C is only used in the pair **ch**.

Easy to read aloud
Swahili is written just as it sounds. Every letter is said — there are no silent letters — and almost every word ends with a vowel.

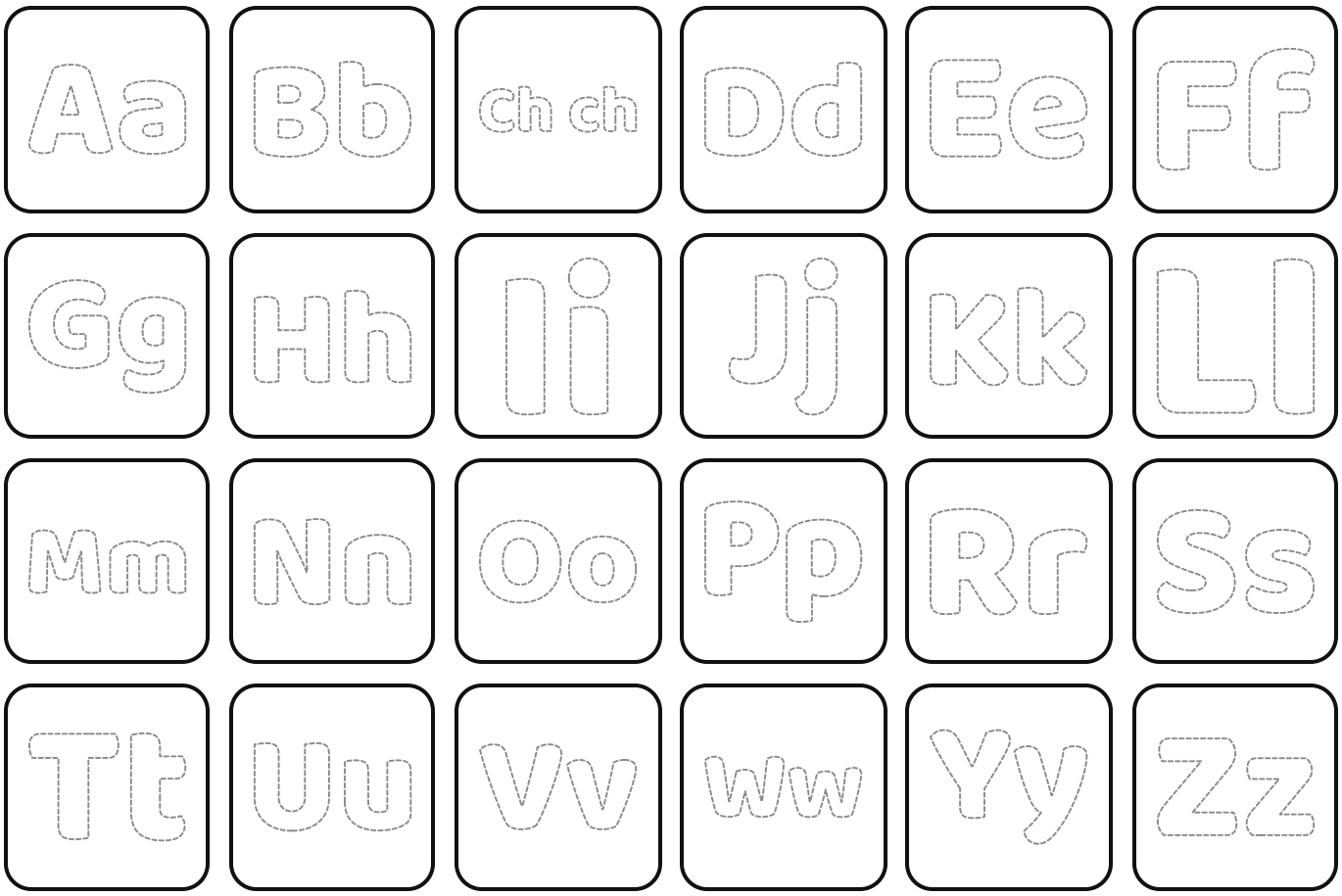
Five pure vowels
A E I O U always say *ah, eh, ee, oh, oo*. Swahili children learn to read by singing the syllables: *ba be bi bo bu, cha che chi cho chu…*

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters herufi za Kiswahili

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · JINA

a

ah

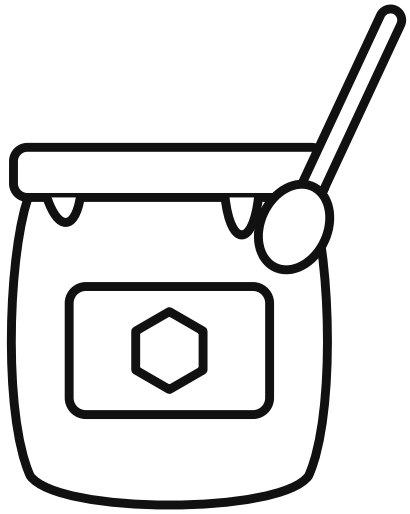
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma · na



AA **IS FOR**

asali

a-SA-lee

honey

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

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Bb

NAME · JINA

be

beh

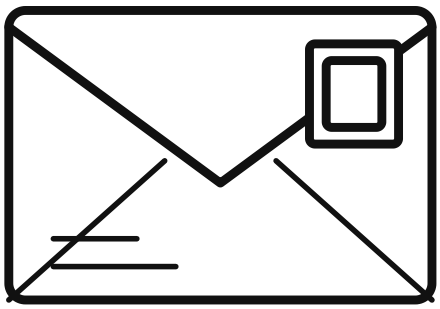
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «be»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



BB IS FOR

barua

ba-ROO-a

a letter to post

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

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Ch ch

NAME · JINA

che

cheh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “church”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Ch ch — «che»

cha · che · chi · cho · chu

Swahili uses C only together with H: **ch**.



CH CH IS FOR

chai

CHA-ee

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch

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Dd

NAME · JINA

de

deh

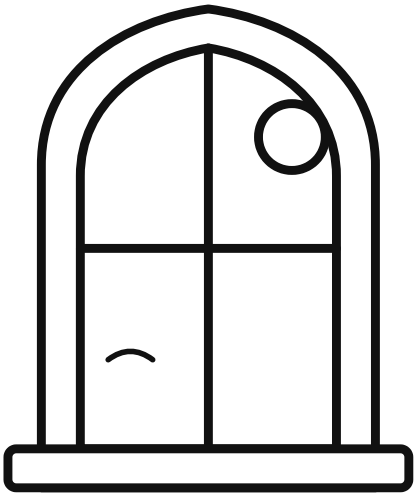
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «de»

da · de · di · do · du



DD IS FOR

dirisha

dee-REE-sha

window

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

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Ee

NAME · JINA

e

eh

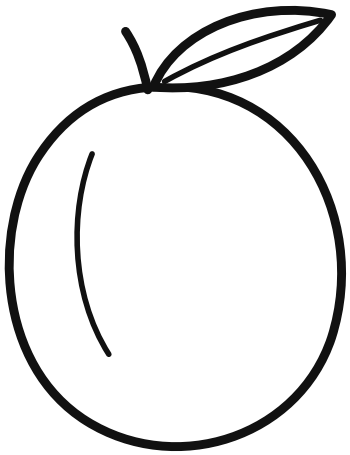
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “bed”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me · ne



EE IS FOR

embe

EM-beh

mango

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

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Ff

NAME · JINA

fe

feh

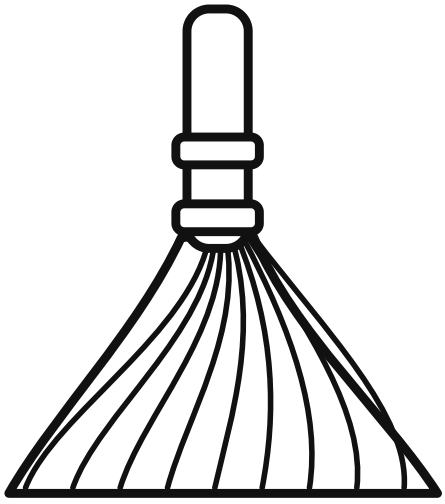
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fe»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

fagio

fa-GEE-o

broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

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Gg

NAME · JINA

ge

geh

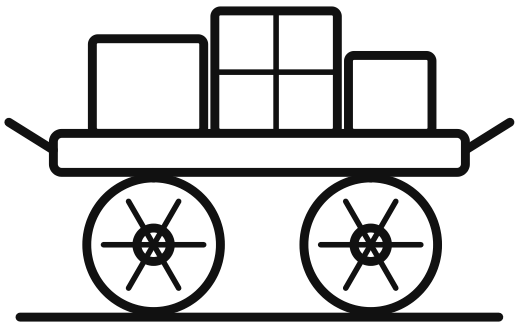
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go” (always hard)

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ge»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



GG IS FOR

gari

GA-ree

cart, car (anything with wheels)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

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Hh

NAME · JINA

he

heh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «he»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu



HH IS FOR

hilali

hee-LA-lee

new crescent moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

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Ii

NAME · JINA

i

ee

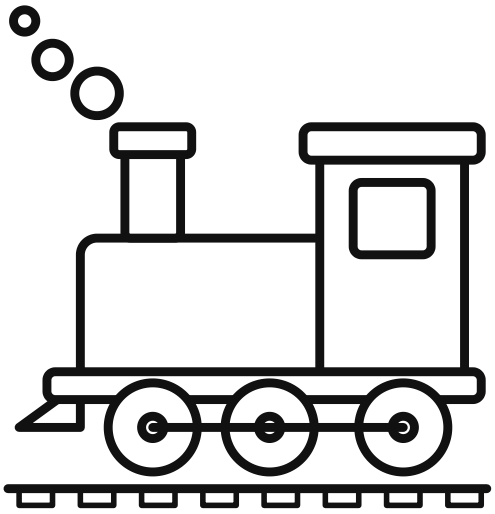
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ee’ as in “see”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi · ni



II IS FOR

injini

een-JEE-nee

engine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

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Jj

NAME · JINA

je

jeh

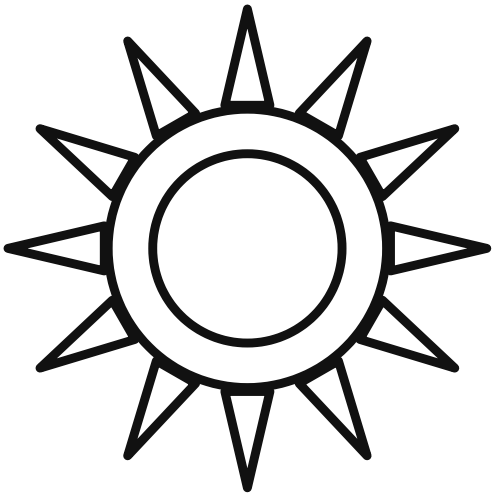
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «je»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



JJ IS FOR

jua

JOO-a

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

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Kk

NAME · JINA

ke

keh

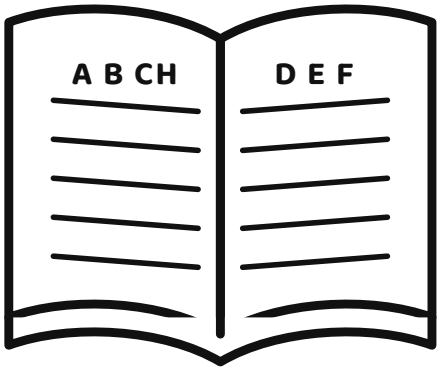
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ke»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku



KK IS FOR

kitabu

kee-TA-boo

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

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Ll

NAME · JINA

le

leh

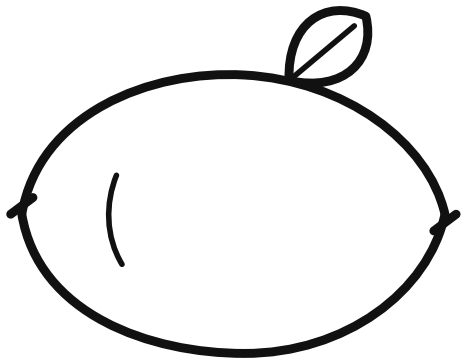
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «le»

la · le · li · lo · lu



LL IS FOR

limau

lee-MA-oo

lemon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ll Ll Ll Ll

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Mm

NAME · JINA

me

meh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

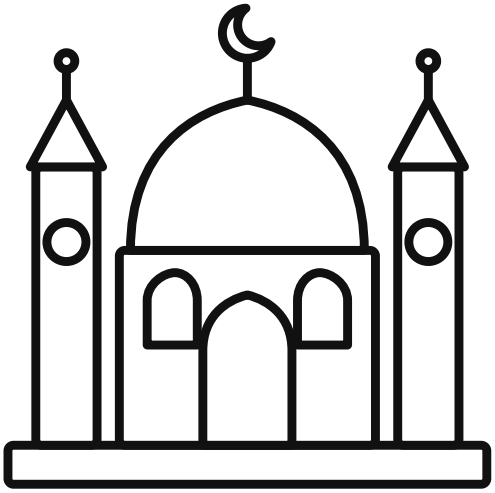
‘m’ as in “moon”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «me»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu

M can be a whole syllable on its own: *m-si-ki-ti*.



MM IS FOR

msikiti

m-see-KEE-tee

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

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Nn

NAME · JINA

ne

neh

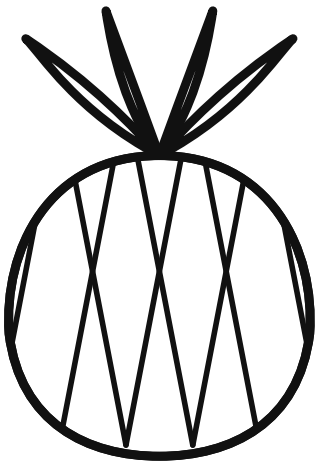
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «ne»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



NN IS FOR

nanasi

na-NA-see

pineapple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

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Oo

NAME · JINA

o

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

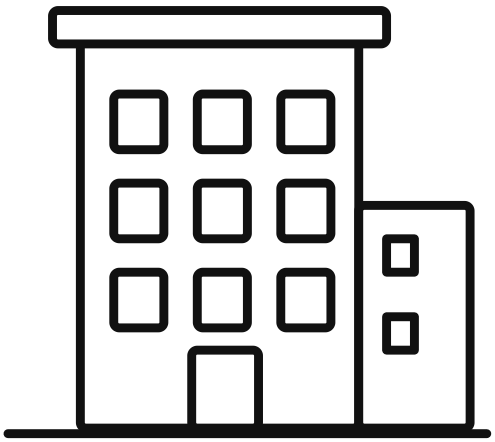
‘o’ as in “more” (short and pure)

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo · no

Not many Swahili words start with O, but O is in almost every sentence!



OO IS FOR

orofa

o-RO-fa

a tall building with floors

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

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Pp

NAME · JINA

pe

peh

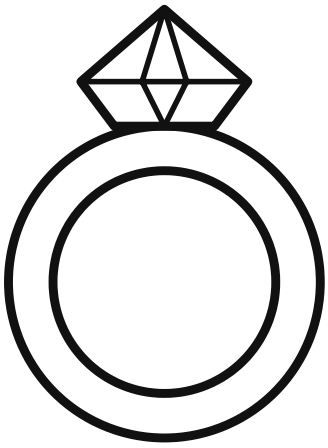
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pe»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



PP IS FOR

pete

PEH-teh

ring

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

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Rr

NAME · JINA

re

reh

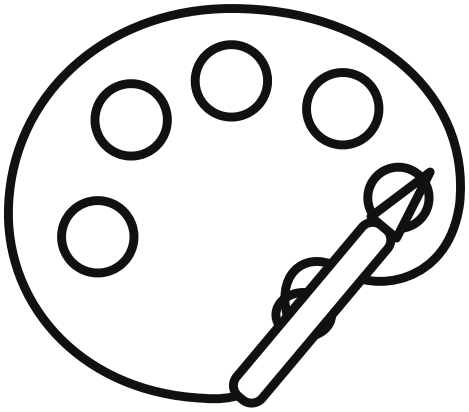
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick tapped ‘r’

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «re»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



RR IS FOR

rangi

RA-ngee

colors, paint

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

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Ss

NAME · JINA

se

seh

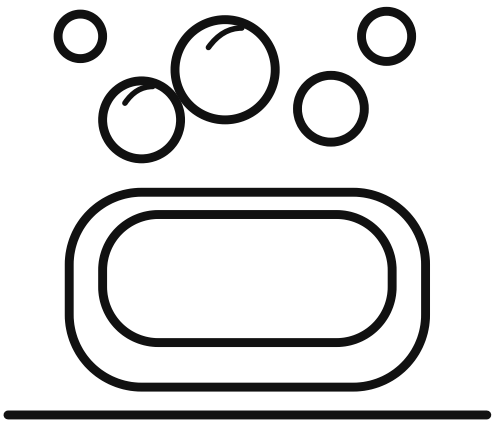
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «se»

sa · se · si · so · su



SS IS FOR

sabuni

sa-BOO-nee

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

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Tt

NAME · JINA

te

teh

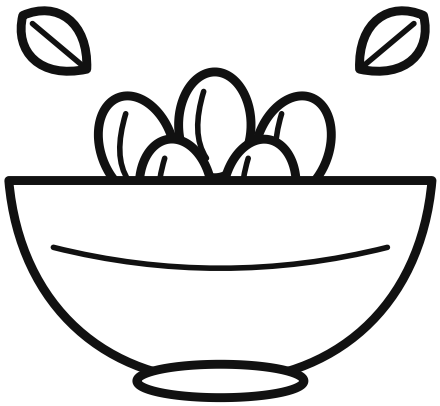
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “tap”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «te»

ta · te · ti · to · tu



TT IS FOR

tende

TEH-ndeh

dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

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Uu

NAME · JINA

u

oo

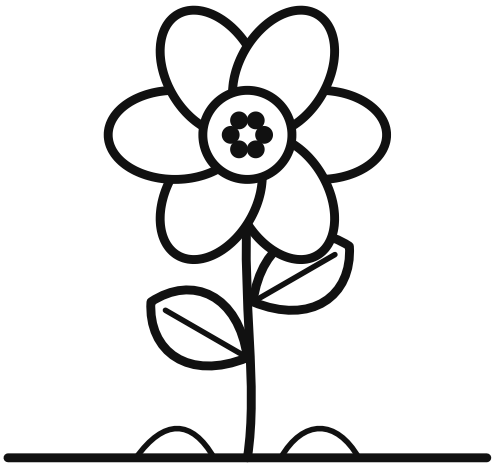
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘oo’ as in “moon”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu · nu



UU IS FOR

ua

OO-a

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

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Vv

NAME · JINA

ve

veh

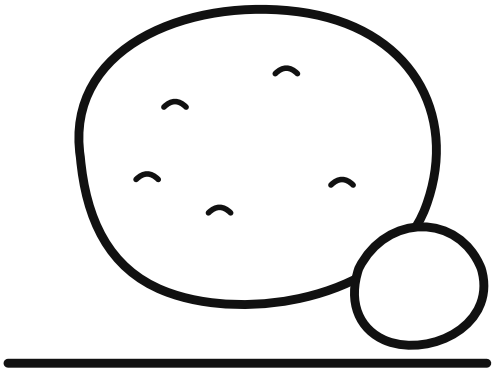
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘v’ as in “van”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

V v — «ve»

va · ve · vi · vo · vu



VV IS FOR

viazi

vee-A-zee

potatoes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Vv Vv Vv Vv

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Ww

NAME · JINA

we

weh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «we»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu



WW **IS FOR**

wali

WA-lee

cooked rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

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Yy

NAME · JINA

ye

yeh

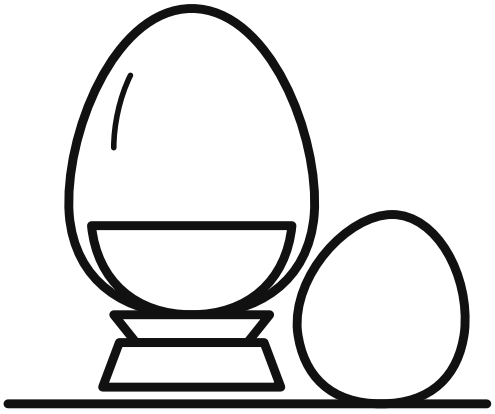
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ye»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu



YY IS FOR

yai

YA-ee

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

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Zz

NAME · JINA

ze

zeh

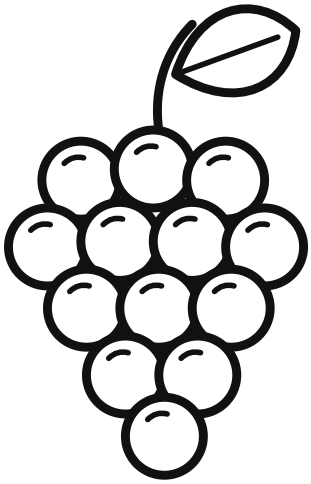
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Z z — «ze»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu



ZZ IS FOR

zabibu

za-BEE-boo

grapes

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Zz Zz Zz Zz

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LETTER PAIRS

Letter Pairs herufi mbili

heh-ROO-fee m-BEE-lee — “two letters”

Some Swahili sounds are written with **two letters together**. You already know one of them: **ch**.

Six more pairs
dh · gh · ng’ · ny · sh · th — each pair makes **one** sound. Many of these sounds came into Swahili with words from Arabic.

Watch the little mark!
ng’ (with the mark) sounds like the end of “sing”; **ng** (no mark) sounds like the middle of “finger”.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letter pairs herufi mbili

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.

Dh dh	Gh gh	Ng' ng'
Ny ny	Sh sh	Th th

Dh dh

NAME · JINA

dha

thah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘th’ as in “this” (buzzy)

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Dh dh — «dha»

dha · dhe · dhi · dho · dhu



DH DH IS FOR

dhoruba

tho-ROO-ba

storm

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh

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Gh gh

NAME · JINA

gha

ghah

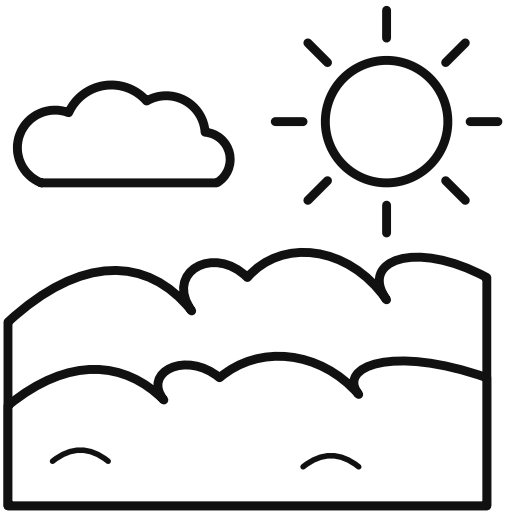
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft gargled ‘g’ from the back of the throat, like Arabic غ

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Gh gh — «gha»

gha · ghe · ghi · gho · ghu



GH GH IS FOR

ghuba

GHOO-ba

bay (where the sea curves into the land)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ng’ ng’

NAME · JINA

ng’a

ngah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ng’ as in “sing” — but Swahili can start a word with it!

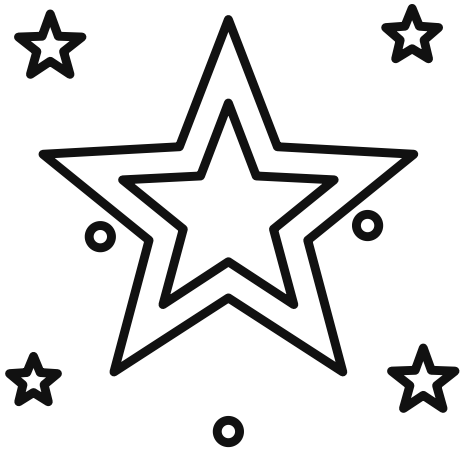
SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Ng’ ng’ — «ng’a»

ng’a · ng’e · ng’i · ng’o · ng’u

ng’ (with the mark) = “si**ng**” · ng (no mark) = “fi**ng**er”

Ng’ hardly ever starts a word you can draw. Find it inside *kung’aa*!



NG’ NG’ IS FOR

kung’aa

koo-NGA-a

to shine, to sparkle

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’

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Ny ny

NAME · JINA

nya

nyah

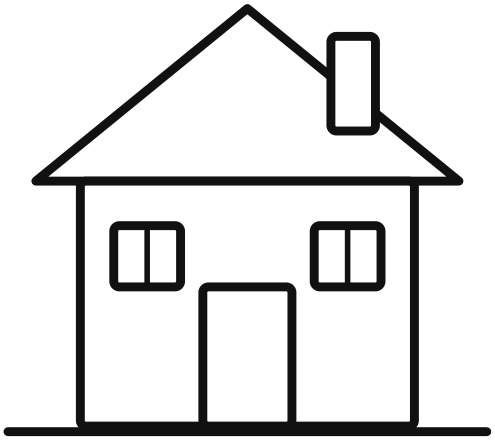
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu



NY NY IS FOR

nyumba

NYOO-mba

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

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Sh sh

NAME · JINA

sha

shah

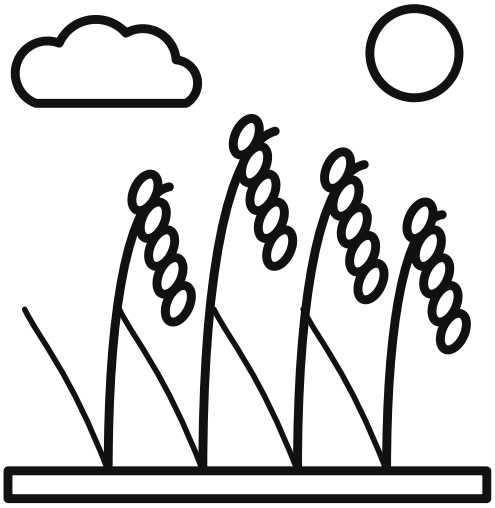
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “ship”

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Sh sh — «sha»

sha · she · shi · sho · shu



SH SH IS FOR

shamba

SHA-mba

farm, field

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh

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Th th

NAME · JINA

tha

thah

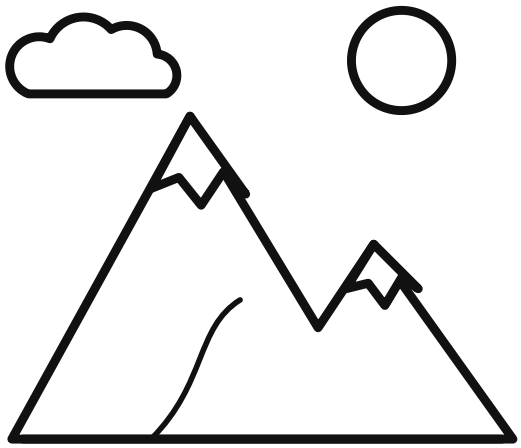
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘th’ as in “think” (soft)

SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES

Th th — «tha»

tha · the · thi · tho · thu



TH TH IS FOR

theluji

theh-LOO-jee

snow (on a mountain top)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA

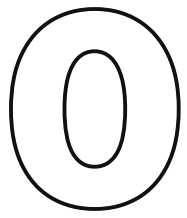
Th th Th th Th th Th th

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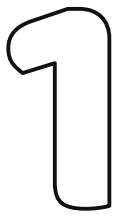
BONUS

Swahili numbers nambari *(nam-BA-ree)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Swahili: *see-FOO-ree, MO-ja, m-BEE-lee, TA-too...*



0
sifuri
see-FOO-ree
zero



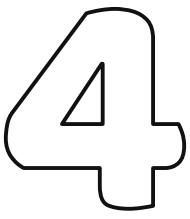
1
moja
MO-ja
one



2
mbili
m-BEE-lee
two



3
tatu
TA-too
three



4
nne
N-neh
four



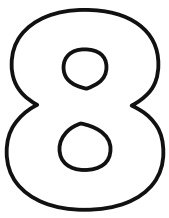
5
tano
TA-no
five



6
sita
SEE-ta
six



7
saba
SA-ba
seven



8
nane
NA-neh
eight



9
tisa
TEE-sa
nine

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LET'S TALK

My first Swahili words Maneno ya kwanza

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum
as-sa-LA-moo a-LAY-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Waalaikum salaam
wa-a-LAY-koom sa-LAAM
And peace be upon you (the reply)

Hujambo? · Sijambo!
hoo-JA-mbo · see-JA-mbo
How are you? · I am fine!

Jina langu ni ...
JEE-na LA-ngoo nee ...
My name is ...

Asante
a-SA-nteh
Thank you

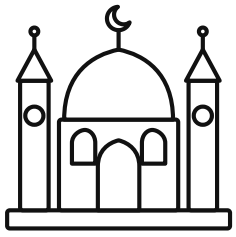
Jazakallahu khairan
ja-za-KAL-la-hoo KHAI-ran
May Allah reward you with good

mama · baba
MA-ma · BA-ba
Mother · Father

kaka · dada
KA-ka · DA-da
Brother · Sister

ndiyo · hapana
n-DEE-yo · ha-PA-na
Yes · No

Ninajifunza Kiswahili!
nee-na-jee-FOO-nza kee-swa-HEE-lee
I am learning Swahili!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

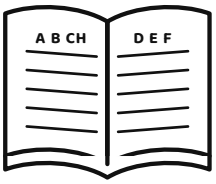
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

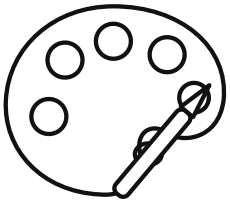
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **30 Swahili letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Swahili, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! Hongera!

MA-sha-la! ho-NGEH-ra! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 30 letters of the Swahili alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.